Winter Season Calendar 2026-2027

This calendar lists the dates that change how you travel with Fernhollow Journeys during the winter season. The ferry timetable is described in the Carrow Ferry Company's own notice, and the dates below are the ones our desk plans around.

The winter timetable

The winter ferry timetable runs from 1 November 2026 to 31 March 2027. During this period the Mirelake to Carrow crossing keeps its daily sailings, including the 23:30 overnight sailing, and the Port Ellery to Carrow route runs only from Friday to Monday. Outside the winter timetable the summer sailings apply, so check the dates on your ticket.

Fixed closures and special sailings

No ferries run on 25 December 2026. Plan your crossings for the days either side of that date, because the desk cannot move a ticket onto a sailing that does not exist.

On 12 December 2026 the Carrow harbour festival brings an extra 19:00 sailing from Mirelake. It is a useful evening crossing for travellers who want to attend the festival and return the same night.

Walking and beach closures

The Brannock Highlands trails close above the snow line from 1 December. Walkers should check the trail notices at the lodge before they set out, and should plan lower routes for the winter months.

Port Ellery's beach huts close from 1 November to 31 March. Huts cannot be hired during this period, so do not book a hut as part of a winter trip.

Markets

The Mirelake winter market opens on Saturdays in December. It runs in the town square beside the Mirelake Quay Hotel, and it is a good reason to plan a stay that includes a Saturday.

Worked example

A traveller plans a four-night stay on the Isle of Carrow from 11 December to 15 December 2026. The trip crosses 12 December, so the traveller can take the 19:00 festival sailing from Mirelake that evening. The trip also crosses 25 December only if it runs to that date, which this one does not, so no ferry is missing from the plan. If the traveller had instead planned to leave on 25 December, the desk would need to move the crossing to 24 or 26 December.

Questions and answers

Are there any ferries on Christmas Day? No. No ferries run on 25 December 2026.

Can I walk in the Brannock Highlands in December? The upper trails close above the snow line from 1 December, so walk the lower routes and check the notices at the lodge.

Can I hire a beach hut in Port Ellery in January? No. The huts are closed from 1 November to 31 March.

When is the extra festival sailing? The 19:00 sailing from Mirelake on 12 December 2026 is added for the harbour festival.